



Rowan Thistle

HEIR TO THISTLEDOWN HOUSE

*“Everyone assumes the jam fortune is yours.
Everyone may be in for a surprise.”*



✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

CORE CHARACTER

ALWAYS IN PLAY

WHAT TO WEAR

A tweed jacket or a soft cardigan, a silk scarf, and the slightly rumpled air of someone who will one day inherit a very large house and a very small budget for heating it.

At the table you are: charming, a little nervous, and always the first to toast Uncle Barty.



Before the party: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.



Starter served: open Round 1 on page 3 when the host calls it.



Main course served: unfold page 3 and open Round 2.



Dessert served: open Round 3 on page 4, then vote.

Printed single-sided, so later rounds can't show through.



THE EVENING

Autumn, the 1930s. Bartholomew “Barty” Thistle, retired jam magnate, has invited a few old friends to the Harvest Supper at Thistledown House. Before the soup was served, Barty took a glass of elderflower cordial in the study, sat down for a rest, and never woke up. Someone at this table knows why.

Never show this booklet to anyone. You may bend the truth about your secret, but never about the evidence.



You are innocent.

You did not harm Barty, and you want the truth to come out.

Your story

Barty is your late mother's brother, and you will inherit Thistledown House one day. Everybody knows it. You run a little bookshop in town, Thistle & Page, and it is sinking fast.

YOUR SECRET

At 5:35, just after Sage came out of the study, you went in and asked Barty for £200 to pay the printer. Barty wrote you a check, then tore it in two and said, "Balance your books first, then ask me." You left at about 5:42, embarrassed, and you would rather nobody knew.

Where you were

5:30	Arrived on the afternoon train.
5:35-5:42	In the study with Barty (the check).
5:45-6:30	At the drawing-room piano. Ellis sat by the fire listening the whole time.
about 6:25	Heard Barty in the hall calling, "Something smells marvelous!"
6:30	Sherry in the drawing room.

Your goal tonight

Find out who harmed your uncle. Keep the check quiet until Round 2. Try to win Best Detective.

If someone asks you...

"Do you inherit?" "The house, yes. Everyone knows that. It is mostly damp and drafts."

"Why did you go to the study?" Before Round 2: "To say hello to my uncle. Is that a crime?" From Round 2, tell the truth.

"Did you see the cordial?" "There was no glass on the desk while I was there. Only the blotter and the pens."

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

Rowan Thistle • Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 • Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

- SHARE THIS • **(MUST SHARE)** From about a quarter to six until Morgan brought the sherry at half past six, I was playing the piano in the drawing room. Ellis sat by the fire and listened the whole time. Neither of us left the room.
- I will inherit the house one day. I would much rather have Uncle Barty back.
- ASK • **Morgan:** “When did you last see Uncle Barty, and where was Barty going?”
- **Sage:** “You were shut in the study with my uncle just before me. What was that meeting about?”
- YOUR TASK Raise a toast to Uncle Barty before the first spoonful, and quietly note who doesn’t raise a glass.



FOLD OR CUT HERE • KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 • Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

- SHARE THIS • **(MUST SHARE)** When I went into the study at 5:35, just after Sage came out, the desk was bare: the blotter, the pen tray and nothing else. No glass, no saucer and no note. I left at about 5:42.
- Once Evidence #6 is out, admit it: the torn check was mine. I asked for £200 for the bookshop and Uncle Barty said no.
- ASK • **Ellis:** “Who could get hold of a sleeping powder like that one?”
- **Sage:** “Where exactly were you between a quarter to six and half past six?”
- YOUR TASK Read Evidence #5 aloud, then ask the table who writes in green ink.

NOTES • ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

Rowan Thistle • Round 3

THEN VOTE

Round 3 · Dessert

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS

- At about 6:25 I heard Uncle Barty come in through the hall, calling out that supper smelled marvelous. That was the last time I heard that cheerful voice.
- Last month Uncle Barty grumbled to me that “the Trust accounts don’t add up.” I thought it was just grumbling.

ASK

- **Morgan:** “Who knew that Uncle Barty drank a glass of cordial before supper every evening?”
- **Sage:** “Who signs for money taken out of the Thistle Trust?”

YOUR TASK

Before the vote, tell the table which piece of evidence convinced you most, and why.

NOTES

SUSPECTS AT A GLANCE (PUBLIC INFORMATION)

#	NAME	ROLE	#	NAME	ROLE
10	Rowan Thistle	Heir to Thistledown House	14	Harper Vale	Food Critic
11	Ellis Fairweather	Family Doctor	15	Quinn Ashby	Head Gardener
12	Morgan Pike	Steward of Thistledown House	16	Avery Lark	Newspaper Reporter
13	Sage Whitlock	Family Solicitor	17	Jules Marchetti	Visiting Chef